ايجار Ijar

SaaS Master class



Case Study

Re-letting a flat from abroad

A WhatsApp agreement, payment and settlement ledger for Egyptians in the Gulf who rent out a flat in Cairo or Giza. Run by hand as a Stage 0 MVP.

Ready to move in?
Let's go! ✨

Sherif Hilal · Founder & PM · November 2026

Discovery report | Prototype | All documents

ijar ايجار



Sherif Hilal

Founder · started November 2026

Stage 0 · concierge

What is Ijar?

A re-let service for owners living abroad, with an **agreement, payment and settlement ledger** built in. Run on WhatsApp and one shared sheet.



≈2.7M

Egyptians in the Gulf M20

Screen · Move-in video · Agree · Log payments · Settle · Re-let

How does Ijar earn?

A fee from owners, paid **only when the tenant moves in**.



- **½ month** re-let fee, half a broker's M17
- **≈5% / month** management (to test, OP14)
- **Later** renewal fee, partners

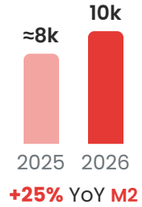
Per re-let at EGP 6,500 rent: **EGP 2,550** contribution; ~10 a month to live on it economics

What industry is Ijar in?

Egypt residential rentals · avg unfurnished asking rent, Greater Cairo

Growth factors

- Old-rent reform ends by 2032 M1
- State rental push: 200k homes M6
- Record $13B remittances M22



+25% YoY M2

Other players

Aqarmap · dubizzle · Property Finder · Rentak · Flatio · Blueground

Objective As founder-PM of Ijar, find one real problem in Egypt's informal rental market and **prove by hand that one unrelated owner pays** for the fix and keeps using it.

What is a re-let?

The moment a tenant leaves and a new one must be found, checked and moved in. For an owner abroad, every step needs someone on the ground.

Tenant gives notice
Find & view
Choose a tenant
Contract & move-in
Live & pay
Dispute or renew



Who opens the flat?
Who is moving in?
What did we agree?

Should Ijar care about the re-let?

100% yes! It is the moment the owner pays, and the record built there earns the monthly relationship.

Notice
Find
Choose
Move-in
Live & pay

Checked tenant
↓
Agreed record
↓
Monthly management

What product outcomes should we focus on?

View KPI tree in the PRD

Revenue (Business outcome) →

- Re-let revenue paid re-lets × ½ month
- Management revenue managed flats × 5%

→

- Owners reached
- **% who pay after offer**
- Ledgers still used
- **% who convert to monthly**

Product outcomes

- More owners pay after seeing the offer
- Both sides keep using the ledger after move-in

Current re-letting ways

Portal ads
Aqarmap, dubizzle: paid packages, no identity checks U2, U3

Facebook & WhatsApp groups
Free, "no brokers", but nobody screens anyone M8, U16

Local brokers
≈ 1 month's rent; some push the price up M17, U5

A relative or the doorman
Opens the flat, judges the tenant by gut feeling U13

How is competition solving it?

Rentak	• Guaranteed rent, screening, deposits, disputes • Compounds and new cities only M15
Aqarmap · dubizzle	• Huge reach, 10M+ installs • Scams, unreachable owners U2, U3
Flatio · Blueground	• Furnished, foreigners, priced in € or $ M16
Saudi "Ejar"	• National rental record both sides register (benchmark) M9

What else do people use?

Finding
groups, posts

Paying
cash, InstaPay, Vodafone Cash

Contract
stationery-shop form

Proof
a WhatsApp screenshot

U12, U14 No receipts; two tenants asked for one out of fear.

Target segment to solve for re-letting?

All rental parties

Tenants

Tenant supply we place. **Not charged** in Stage 0

Owners (payers)

Local owner · 9/15

Owner abroad · 12/15

Local owners: brokers and groups already work "well enough"

20 ICPs scored on pain, reach and willingness to pay Step 01b

Why choose owners abroad?

- **Budget already exists:** they pay a broker about a month M17
- **Sharpest pain:** can't attend viewings, rely on a relative
- **Easy to find:** Gulf numbers on ads, expat groups M20
- **Less competition:** Rentak stays in compounds M15
- **Earn in hard currency** while local wages are flat M22

Major problems they face?

Hypothesis

- They **can't control who moves in**: viewings depend on a relative or doorman
- They pay **≈1 month** to a broker for a tenant nobody checked
- **Nothing agreed is written down**: cash, screenshots, no condition record
- When damage or non-payment happens, **court takes years** U12



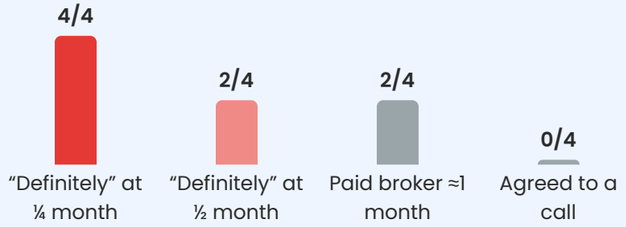
Let’s hear it directly from OWNERS and TENANTS now! Evidence library U1–U16, M1–M22

Survey

Tenant survey: 4 full + 6 free-text replies · Owner survey: 0 so far · tenant link · owner link

- **3/4** Found their home in a Facebook or WhatsApp group
- **3/4** Could only partly check the neighbours before signing
- **3/4** Say a note on the building and neighbours is very important
- **Norm** Cash, InstaPay or Vodafone Cash, with a screenshot as the only proof U14

Price and commitment signals U16



Recurring disputes U14

- Who pays for painting, a water motor or a roof leak (one split ⅓ tenant, ⅔ owner)
- Contracts kept to 1 year so the rent can rise every year
- Deposits of 1–2 months, often not returned M4

Voices

Owners, tenants and reviews in their own words (translated)

“I don’t rent to lawyers, they’re trouble.”
Owner, 6+ flats · U12

“It’s empty now… he didn’t pay the utilities, I said I’d lock the iron door on him.”
Owner · U13

“He keeps the contract to one year so he can raise the rent every year.”
Tenant · U14

“I can’t reach the owner… nobody calls me back.”
Aqarmap review · U2

“The broker raises the rent to take a higher commission.”
Facebook post · U5

“The owner fools them… there’s an electricity or water fault.”
Students, relayed · U15

Secondary research

- **+25%** Unfurnished asking rents in Greater Cairo, year on year (2026) M2
- **1 mo** Broker commission on a rental is about one month’s rent M17
- **Most** landlords don’t return the deposit, “under various pretexts” M4

Owners keep flats empty
“Many flats stay closed because owners fear non-payment or a tenant who won’t leave.” M10, TV segment

Key takeaways

- Deals stay informal: cash, InstaPay, and a screenshot as proof
- The same disputes repeat: repairs, deposits, yearly rent rises
- Court is avoided: one case ran for years and the rent stopped
- Screening is gut feeling: a doorman’s word, or banning whole jobs
- Renting happens on WhatsApp and Facebook, not apps
- **Owners abroad haven’t replied yet:** the biggest open risk

أ. محمود



Primary Persona · Owner abroad

"Find me someone I can trust without flying back or paying a broker's month, and keep a record we both agreed to."

Busy · Cautious · In Riyadh

Pain points

- His brother or the doorman opens every viewing
- Pays ≈1 month to a broker for a stranger
- No record of the flat or the deal

Goals

- Re-let without travelling
- Know who moves in first
- Settle problems without court

أسرة كريم



Secondary Persona · Tenant family

"We just want the flat as described, clear rules on repairs, and our deposit back."

Budget-tight · Long-term

Pain points

- Deposit kept for old damage
  M4
- No receipts, only screenshots
  U14
- Can't check the neighbours
  U16

Goals

- A flat that works on day one
- Clear who repairs what
- Deposit returned

Mahmoud's re-let journey (the owner abroad)

Not linear in real life, but the pains stay the same · owner journey

Phase	Tenant gives notice	Find & view	Choose tenant	Contract & move-in	Live & pay	Dispute
Activities	Hears on WhatsApp in Riyadh	Posts in groups, calls a broker, sends his brother	Agrees on voice notes	Stationery-shop contract, no photos	Cash or InstaPay, screenshots	Threatens, waits, or goes to court
Emotions						
Thoughts	*"Who will open the flat?"*	*"Is the broker pushing the price?"*	*"I've never met them"*	*"What did we actually agree?"*	*"Did he pay the utilities?"*	*"Court will take years"*
Touchpoints						
Ijar solution	✅ Intake call · US1	✅ Viewings + voice notes · US2	✅ ID, job, last landlord · US3	✅ Dated video + checklist · US4–5	✅ Payment log · US6	✅ Settlement in 48 h · US7



What seems like the TRUE PROBLEM? ✨

Owners abroad lose control and about two months' rent on every re-let, and have no agreed record when something goes wrong.

Why Because they can't be there, so a broker and a relative decide who moves in

Why Because there is no checked, trusted channel for owners outside compounds

Why Because deals are informal: cash, screenshots, an unregistered contract

Why Because there is no shared record, so disputes stall or go to court for years U12

Why do they even need a record?

- *So "was it already broken?" has an answer*
- *So rent and deposit terms can't be rewritten later*
- *So a dispute ends in days, not years in court*

Is this a real problem?

From people

- **3 of 4** tenants found homes in groups, with no checks U16
- **2 owners**: a bad tenant and an empty flat; years in court U12, U13
- **6 tenants** name the same repair and deposit fights U14

Secondary research

- Broker ≈ **1 month's rent** per rental M17
- Saudi Arabia built **Ejar**, a national rental record, for this gap M9

Why should we solve it now?

Market dynamics

- **Jan 2026:** brokers must register with GOEIC (Decision 578/2025) M21
- Rents **+25%** in a year: more moves, more disputes M2
- Old rent ends by **2032**, pushing families into new rent M1
- Record **$13B** remittances: owners abroad have flats and money M22

What is the value generated by solving this problem?

For owners and tenants

- Re-let without travelling back
- Save about half a broker's month
- A checked tenant, before approval
- A dated video of the flat
- One record both sides confirmed
- Disputes settled in 48 h, not years

For Ijar

- Revenue on every re-let, paid on move-in
- Trust that earns a monthly fee
- A difference brokers and Rentak don't offer
- Works before broker registration
- Real data on hours, prices and disputes
- A path from one district to many



What are the ways we can solve this problem?



How can Ijar help owners abroad re-let safely, and keep a record both sides trust?

15	5	2	1
ideas, 5 lenses	shortlisted ★	advanced	built by hand

	Sol 1 · Re-let + agreement ledger (OP2 + OP1)	Sol 2 · Lead with monthly management (OP14)
Market size	**5/10** ≈100 owner-abroad re-lets a month per district	**5/10** same owners, monthly
Tech fit	**8/10** WhatsApp + sheet, no app	**7/10** monthly visits and rent collection
Economic fit	**6/10** rising rents mean more disputes	**6/10** owners earn hard currency
Regulatory fit	**8/10** logging an agreement isn't brokerage	**6/10** may count as brokerage (M21)
Value · Effort	**8 · 3** Quick win	**7 · 6** Big bet
Market fit	**6.75** Medium confidence ⭐	**6.0** Low confidence: test as a question

OP2 ⭐
Agreement, payment, settlement ledger
Build now

OP1
Proof-of-life move-in video
Fold into OP2

OP14
Monthly management
Ask as a question

OP12
WhatsApp-bot intake
Park

OP13
Charge the tenant
Park (plan B)

Scores out of 10, equal weights · Phase 3 market fit · Phase 4 builder fit · all 15 opportunities



Why might the ledger work?

Fits current behaviour

- Renting already lives on WhatsApp and Facebook U16
- Payments already go by InstaPay or Vodafone Cash; we only log them U14
- Tenants already ask for receipts out of fear U12

User psychology

- One word, **موافق**, readable aloud: works for low tech comfort
- A written "yes" from both sides is hard to walk back later

"ده سجل للاتفاق بينكم، مش عقد قانوني" — a record of your agreement, not a legal contract. In every first message (FR9).

How will this solution benefit Ijar?

- Stands apart from brokers and Rentak
- Earns the right to a monthly fee
- Works before broker registration
- Costs almost nothing to run
- Real data from every re-let
- The sheet becomes the app's data model

How will the solution look? ✨

If Mahmoud, an owner in Riyadh, re-lets his flat in Haram with Ijar…



1 **Gets the offer, replies with his flat details**



2 **Books an intake call for the same evening**



3 **Voice note after each viewing, then the screening**



4 **Dated move-in video; agrees with one word: موافق**

The offer, sent as one image

بنأجّر شقتك وإنت برّه، بنص سعر السمسار، ومعاك سجل لكل حاجة اتفقتوا عليها

We re-let your flat while you're abroad, for half a broker's fee, with a record of everything you agree.

💰 **½ month's rent, only when the tenant moves in.** Nothing up front. No tenant found, no fee.

🔒 **Fee gate:** no fee until GOEIC confirms the broker-registration rules (FR10).



Play the clickable prototype

Read the one-page PRD

How will the solution look? ✨ …then the tenant, the shared ledger, a dispute and the founder's tracker



5 **Karim's family confirms the same checklist**



6 **Later, the tenant reports a broken water heater**

7 The shared ledger: every item confirmed by both sides

Flat · الهرم · 8,000 ج

Owner: أ. محمود (Riyadh) · Tenant: أسرة كريم

Both-sides confirmation (the number that matters)

100%

Move-in video · 12 Nov 2026 (linked)

Agreement US5 FR6

ITEM	AGREED	STATUS
Monthly rent	8,000 ج، تُدفع أول كل شهر	Confirmed by both
Deposit	شهر واحد (8,000 ج)، يبرجع خلال 14 يوم من التسليم	Confirmed by both
What counts as damage	أي تلف مش موجود في فيديو الاستلام	Confirmed by both
Notice period	شهرين من أي طرف	Confirmed by both
Who repairs what	السباكة والكهربا الأساسية على المالك، الاستهلاك اليومي على المستأجر	Confirmed by both

An item counts only when both sides reply موافق.

8 Settled from the record and video, within 48 h

Dispute #1 · Water heater US7 FR8

Open, founder to review within 48 h

المستأجر: "السخان باظ. صاحب الشقة بيقول عليّا."

What the record says

- Move-in video, 4:12: heater working ✓
- Agreement, "Who repairs what": basic plumbing and electrics are the owner's (confirmed by both)
- No change logged since move-in

We compare the claim with the record and the video, never with one side's word. If it's still unresolved, both

9 Founder tracks every owner messaged

Commitment tracker FR2

OWNER	DISTRICT	OUTCOME	DATE
أ. محمود · Riyadh	الهرم	Interested → call booked	10 Nov
Owner 2 · Dubai	الهرم	No reply	10 Nov
Owner 3 · Kuwait	فيصل	Not now, tenant stays	11 Nov
Owner 4 · Jeddah	الهرم	Asked about price	11 Nov

Play all 9 steps in the prototype | User stories US1–US7 and FR1–FR10 | Sample data · nothing is sent

How will the MVP run behind the scenes?

Owner · WhatsApp
offer, intake, voice notes, موافق

1 ⟷

Founder
viewings, screening, video, settlement

2 ⟷

Tenant · WhatsApp
same video and checklist, موافق

3 the founder writes every confirmed line to ↓

Ledger sheet per flat
agreement · payments · changes · disputes

Videos and photos
dated, linked from each line

Commitment tracker
one row per owner (Step 03c)

Fee gate
blocked until GOEIC answers (FR10)

No money is held. Later, only after Stage 0 passes: a WhatsApp bot at 50+ leads a week (OP12), then an app on the same data.

What can go wrong?

No owner pays (risk 9/9)
Ask for a written yes. After 20 silent messages, test tenants or company HR as payers

Charging = unregistered broker (M21)
Call GOEIC 19591 or a lawyer; no fee until answered (FR10)

Ledger mistaken for legal protection
Disclaimer in every first message (FR9)

Less literate users can't follow it
Read it aloud to 3 people; pass at 3 of 3

How will we measure success?

Type	Metric	Pass	Why?
North Star	Paid re-lets where both sides still use the ledger a month later	**1 owner**	The Stage 0 exit: value for both sides and for us
L1	Owners interested after the offer (A10)	**≥ 3 of 10**	Is the pain strong enough to reply?
L2	Owners who accept ½ month in writing (R1)	**≥ 1**	Willingness to pay at our price
Adoption	Checklist items confirmed by both at move-in	**100%**	The record only works if both agree
Engagement	Payments logged and confirmed each month	**every one**	The habit behind monthly management
Guardrail	A side refuses to confirm, or goes to court	**0**	Then the record isn't trusted
Operations	Hours per re-let (R5) · settlement time	**≤ 10 h · ≤ 48 h**	Can one founder deliver it?

Source: PRD, "How we measure" · thresholds · next: message 10 owners this week (A10)

ijar Thank you! Wishing every flat a good tenant :)

Report + PRD

Prototype | All documents